

Agent Traffic Flow Management

Forecasting and Admission Control for LLM Agent Fleets

Alexander Aghili

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Abstract

Large language model (LLM) agents alternate between inference and external tool execution. A serving system can therefore observe sessions that are likely to generate future requests before those requests arrive. We investigate whether this information improves aggregate demand forecasts and whether acting on the forecasts benefits latency-sensitive sessions. Agent Traffic Flow Management (ATFM) combines a session-state demand model, a tool-progress sidecar, and an admission proxy that can defer background requests. Across two public coding-agent corpora, the ratio of Kalman-baseline loss to elapsed-time-model loss ranges from 1.96 to 5.43 at five-minute horizons and from 2.73 to 5.09 at fifteen-minute horizons, using the 0.9-quantile pinball loss averaged over three seeds. In a separate collection of long-running tools, progress information reduces mean pinball loss from 24.9 to 8.9 seconds. Closed-loop simulation exposes a conditional benefit: in a loaded regime with short interactive tools, forecast-based holds improve session-weighted service-level-objective attainment by 9.3 percentage points while increasing mean background completion time by approximately 24%. A regime with long interactive tools and a shorter hold cap does not establish an advantage over rules-based admission, and a controlled cap ablation in the loaded regime removes the gain entirely: at a 60-second cap the forecast arms' SLO differences from native span zero while their background costs remain, and a same-rule lookahead fed true demand does no better. These findings support session-aware forecasting but show that the measured policy gain depends on long deferral of background work; they do not isolate a benefit attributable to forecast accuracy. A revised capacity rule reduces unnecessary deferral but still does not establish an SLO gain. Serving results remain conditional on an unvalidated simulator and require hardware evaluation.

Keywords: LLM serving; agent workloads; probabilistic forecasting; admission control; KV cache.

1 Introduction

An LLM agent typically executes a sequence of model calls and external actions: a generated response invokes a tool, the tool produces a result, and that result becomes part of a subsequent prompt. While the tool runs, the session does not require inference compute, but its retained key-value (KV) cache may reduce the cost of resumption. Concurrent agents consequently create a scheduling problem that spans both requests already queued at the engine and sessions executing outside it.

Our premise is that the latter group provides useful information about future demand. A session's current phase, elapsed tool time, context length, and available progress reports constrain when it may next request inference. This information is particularly relevant when many active sessions share a serving pool. It is less useful when new sessions dominate arrivals, external actions are unobservable, or uncertainty in return times overwhelms the controller's decision horizon.

Figure 1 provides a running example. At the forecast time, three sessions are outside the model server. Two return during the next 30 seconds, while the third remains in its tool phase. The server has not received those two requests yet, but their elapsed execution and context sizes already provide evidence about future load. Our method formalizes this observation, first at the session level and then across the fleet.

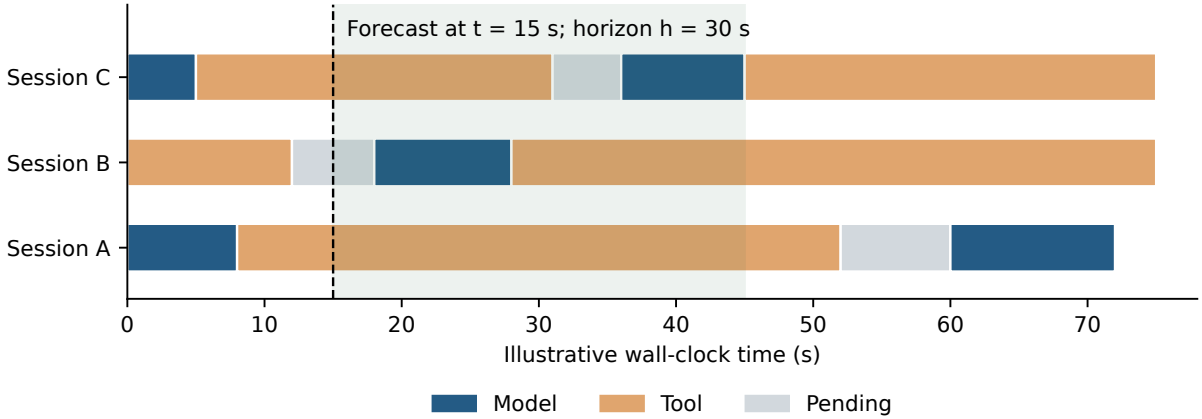


Figure 1: Illustrative agent timelines, not measured traces. Blue denotes model execution, orange tool execution, and gray a pending gap. The dashed line is the observation time; the shaded interval is the forecast horizon. Sessions B and C next request inference inside this horizon; A returns later.

ATFM maintains a *demand board* that aggregates per-session return-time distributions into forecasts of prompt-token and KV-block demand. An admission proxy uses these forecasts to delay deferrable work when interactive demand is expected to exceed available capacity. The name refers to the separation between demand prediction and ground-delay decisions in air-traffic flow management; the implemented controller is a heuristic, without an optimality or service-level guarantee.

This report makes three contributions. First, it defines and implements a common forecast interface that separates the value of request history, elapsed tool time, and live progress. Second, it evaluates these information sources using held-out coding-agent traces and instrumented tool executions. Third, it measures the latency and background-completion trade-off of forecast-based holds in closed-loop simulation, including a no-hold ablation and a regime in which the policy does not outperform a simpler alternative. Forecast evaluation and policy evaluation are kept distinct because changing admission times changes subsequent agent arrivals.

The evidence addresses three research questions: **H1a**, whether in-flight session state improves fleet-demand forecasting over aggregate history; **H1b**, whether progress improves remaining-time prediction beyond elapsed time; and **H2**, whether forecast-based admission improves interactive latency at an explicitly measured cost to background work. The implementation and experiment records are described in Appendix A.

2 Background and Related Work

The running example raises two related questions: what state should remain available while an agent is away, and how should its eventual return affect scheduling? Prior systems address different parts of this problem. We first review the cache and program abstractions, then explain where ATFM’s forecast interface fits.

2.1 Why tool execution matters to the cache

A completed model turn does not necessarily end an agent session. Continuum studies the cost of discarding or offloading KV state between turns and retains selected caches with a time-to-live policy informed by reload cost and queueing delay [1]. Its motivating diagram (Figure 2) makes the return path explicit: the tool interval separates two inference intervals, and cache handling can add work or delay before the second begins. This motivates observing a session throughout its external execution.

End-of-turn KV Cache Eviction

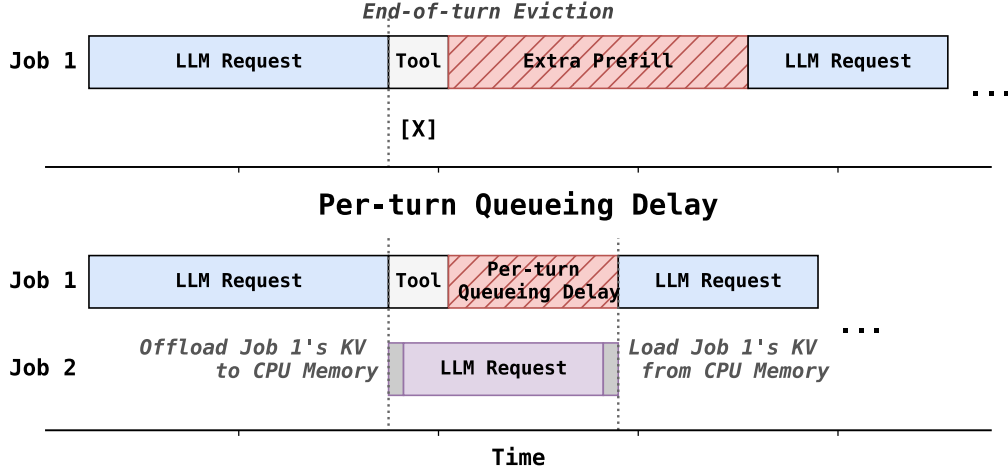


Figure 2: Cache handling across agent turns, reproduced from Li et al., *Continuum*, Figure 1, arXiv:2511.02230v7 [1]. The diagram contrasts end-of-turn eviction with CPU offloading and illustrates the resulting resumption overhead. Original diagram, unchanged except for scaling and SVG-to-PDF conversion; reproduced under the arXiv distribution’s CC BY 4.0 license.

2.2 From requests to programs

ThunderAgent represents multi-turn workflows as programs and coordinates inference and tool resources [2]. Figure 3 shows its program queue and backend resource metadata. The distinction between reasoning and acting matters because a program can remain active even when it has no request executing at the model server. This wider scheduling boundary motivates ATFM’s registry of in-flight sessions.

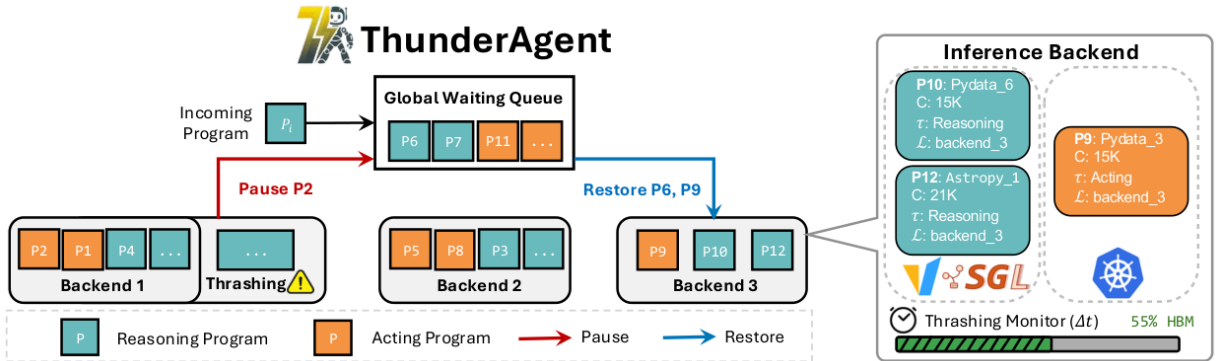


Figure 3: Program-aware resource management, reproduced from Kang et al., *ThunderAgent*, Figure 3, arXiv:2602.13692v3 [2]. Programs can be paused or restored according to backend state. Original diagram, unchanged except for scaling; reproduced under CC BY 4.0. Terminology and architecture in this diagram belong to ThunderAgent.

ATFM takes a complementary measurement perspective: it estimates aggregate first-resumption demand over explicit horizons and tests admission decisions driven by that estimate. Its history predictor and working-set policy are local baselines, not reproductions of Continuum or ThunderAgent. Their results cannot be interpreted as comparisons against either complete published system.

2.3 Progress signals and reactive alternatives

Liu et al. recover live tool progress for cache-management decisions [3], motivating the information source studied in H1b. ATFM does not claim novelty for extracting progress; it studies how session predictions aggregate and when a fleet controller benefits from them. ConServe instead emphasizes conversation-level observation and disaggregated scheduling [4]. This alternative motivates a rules-only baseline: a controller may benefit from session context without needing accurate duration predictions.

2.4 Infrastructure and workload evidence

NVIDIA Dynamo provides request hints, scheduling, and KV-aware serving infrastructure [5]. ATFM integrates a proxy with Dynamo’s Mocker path, while the policy experiments use a separate local engine model. DSec demonstrates stateful sandbox execution decoupled from GPU training [6]. Its reported scale—approximately three million sandboxes per day and more than 380,000 concurrent sandboxes—motivates tracking external execution, but does not establish demand predictability. TraceLab [7] and the SemiAnalysis AgentX corpus [8] provide the real session traces used here.

These systems establish the relevance of state outside the serving queue. The next section defines precisely what ATFM predicts from that state; Section 4 then describes how the proxy consumes the prediction.

3 Demand Model and Forecasting Method

The construction proceeds in three steps: define the demand target, estimate each session’s next return, and aggregate those estimates into a fleet distribution. Figure 4 summarizes the information flow. Throughout, a forecast describes uncertainty about the next request; it is not a reservation of serving capacity.

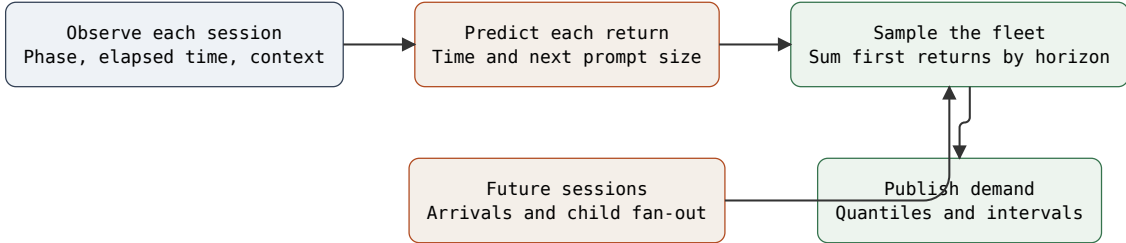


Figure 4: From observed session state to a distribution of fleet demand. Each Monte Carlo draw combines predicted first returns with modeled future-session demand. Quantiles are computed after aggregation, preserving the distinction between individual return uncertainty and aggregate load.

3.1 Forecast target

At time t , let $A_c(t)$ denote known sessions in class c , where the classes are interactive and background. For session i , let $R_i(t)$ be the time until its next model request and L_i the input-token count of that request. With block size $b = 16$ tokens, the KV-demand forecast is

$$D_c^{\text{KV}}(t, h) = \sum_{i \in A_c(t)} \mathbf{1}[R_i(t) \leq h] \left\lceil \frac{L_i}{b} \right\rceil + U_c^{\text{KV}}(t, h). \quad (1)$$

The term U represents demand from future sessions, including modeled child sessions and exogenous arrivals. Replacing $\lceil L_i/b \rceil$ with L_i gives the prompt-token target. Each session contributes only its first

request in a horizon. Thus, these targets measure first-resumption demand, not all requests in the interval, instantaneous resident KV occupancy, or cache-miss-adjusted prefill work. The distinction matters because retention, prefix sharing, and repeated calls can change actual memory and compute requirements.

Known context length informs the next prompt size, but the size increment from tool output must be predicted. The live proxy also uses a character-count approximation when token counts are unavailable. Context size is therefore not assumed to be known exactly in deployment.

For clarity, the main quantities are collected in Table 1. Let $\mathcal{I}_t$ denote all information available by time t , and write $B_i = \lceil L_i/b \rceil$. Linearity of expectation gives

$$\mathbb{E}[D_c^{\text{KV}}(t, h) \mid \mathcal{I}_t] = \sum_{i \in A_c(t)} \mathbb{E}[B_i \mathbf{1}[R_i(t) \leq h] \mid \mathcal{I}_t] + \mathbb{E}[U_c^{\text{KV}}(t, h) \mid \mathcal{I}_t]. \quad (2)$$

If each B_i is fixed, its term simplifies to $B_i p_i(h)$, where $p_i(h) = \Pr(R_i(t) \leq h \mid \mathcal{I}_t)$. This identity does not require independent return times. For example, two known sessions of 100 and 200 blocks with return probabilities 0.8 and 0.3 contribute an expected $100(0.8) + 200(0.3) = 140$ blocks, before future-session demand. The expectation alone does not determine an upper quantile: dependence and dispersion also matter.

Table 1: Core notation. Times are measured in seconds and token counts in tokens unless stated otherwise.

Symbol	Meaning
$t, h, c, A_c(t)$	Observation time, forecast horizon, workload class, and known sessions of that class.
$R_i(t), L_i, B_i$	Time to the next model request, its prompt length, and its demand in KV blocks.
$b, D_c^{\text{KV}}, U_c^{\text{KV}}$	Tokens per block (16), total first-resumption demand, and the future-session contribution, both in blocks.
$T, e, r, S(u)$	Total tool duration, elapsed duration, candidate remaining duration, and survival probability $S(u) = \Pr(T > u)$.
$\mathcal{I}_t, M, \tau$	Information observed by time t , number of Monte Carlo draws, and quantile level.

3.2 State and predictor hierarchy

The registry distinguishes model execution, tool execution, and a pending phase between tool completion and the next request. Events carry session identity, workload class, timestamps, tool identity, backend identity, and optional progress or data signals. Trace adapters map these events to a common table with one row per model call and its associated tool phase. Pending gaps are modeled separately; treating every completed tool as an immediate request would systematically misrepresent human and harness delays.

Table 2: Forecast models and the information available to each. All session models use the same aggregation procedure.

Model	Information and prediction rule
B0: persistence	Point forecast equal to the most recently realized demand window.
B1: Kalman	Local linear trend over realized demand; predictive Gaussian samples clipped at zero.
B2: history	Unconditional empirical tool-duration samples, minus elapsed time and clipped at zero.
M1: survival	Tool-duration samples conditioned on the tool still running at the current elapsed time.
M2: progress	M1 augmented with progress-rate estimation and a learned mapping from reported progress to elapsed-time fraction.
M3: backend	Progress prediction augmented with a shared backend slowdown factor; exploratory only.

B2 uses elapsed time in the final subtraction but does not condition its duration distribution on survival. For tool duration T and elapsed time e , the idealized survival model instead uses

$$\Pr(T - e > r \mid T > e) = \frac{S(e+r)}{S(e)}, \quad r \geq 0, \quad (3)$$

where S is the survival function.

Conditioning removes durations incompatible with a tool that is still running. In the illustrative history $T \in \{10, 20, 40, 80\}$ seconds with equal weights, a tool observed at $e = 30$ seconds can have remaining time 10 or 50 seconds under M1, each with probability one half. B2 instead maps the two already-finished historical durations to zero, placing half its mass on immediate completion (Figure 5). The empirical M1 conditional CDF, before fallback and gap handling, is

$$\hat{F}_{R|e}(r) = \frac{\sum_{j=1}^{n_T} \mathbf{1}[e < T_j \leq e+r]}{\sum_{j=1}^{n_T} \mathbf{1}[T_j > e]}, \quad r \geq 0, \quad (4)$$

where T_j is a historical duration and n_T is the number of available durations. A zero denominator requires the implementation's finite-sample fallback; Equation (4) alone is undefined in that case.

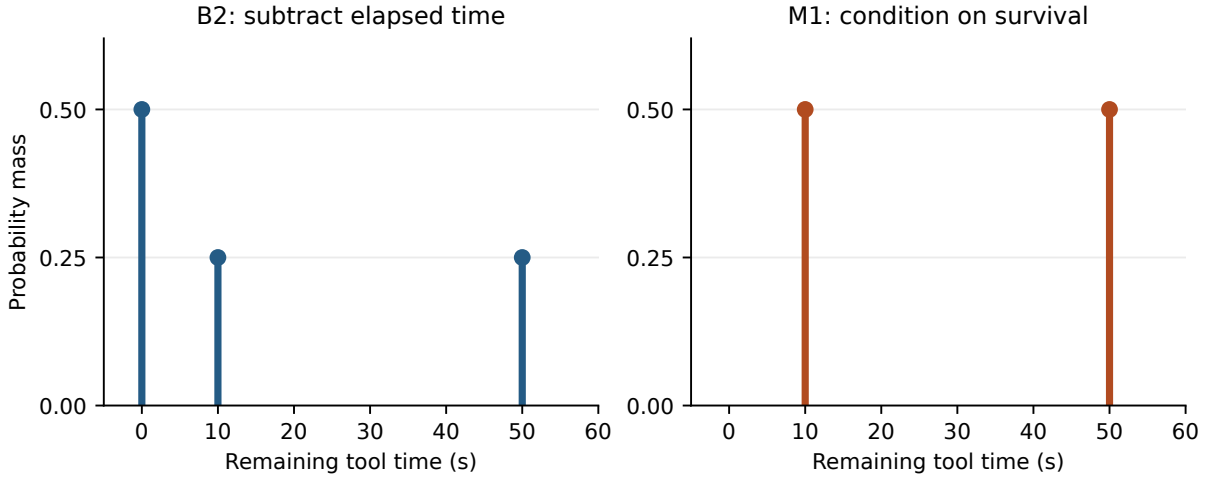


Figure 5: Illustrative remaining-time distributions for the same four historical durations at elapsed time 30 s. Vertical stems are probability masses, not densities. Conditioning excludes completed historical cases instead of interpreting them as evidence of immediate completion.

The implementation uses empirical duration distributions with finite-sample fallbacks, adds a tool-to-request gap, and assigns probability mass to sessions that do not return. M2 combines a rate filter with empirical progress curves because a tool's reported fraction complete need not be linear in wall-clock time. When progress is absent, M2 falls back to the elapsed-time model.

To see why a progress curve is needed, let $p \in (0, 1]$ be the reported fraction of work completed and $g(p)$ the learned fraction of wall-clock duration elapsed at that report. If the report arrives at elapsed time e_ℓ , the curve-based central estimate at current elapsed time e is

$$\hat{T} = \frac{e_\ell}{g(p)}, \quad \hat{R}_{\text{tool}} = \max\left(\frac{e_\ell}{g(p)} - e, 0\right). \quad (5)$$

Here $\hat{T}$ estimates total tool duration, and $\hat{R}_{\text{tool}}$ excludes the subsequent pending gap. The implementation adds sampled multiplicative dispersion and residual variation, so this central estimate is not the full predictive distribution. When no learned curve is available, the rate-based branch samples a work rate v and estimates remaining time from $(W - w)/v$, where W and w are total and completed work units, with adjustment for report age. Figure 6 shows how two different mappings of reported progress change the estimate even with identical observed elapsed time.

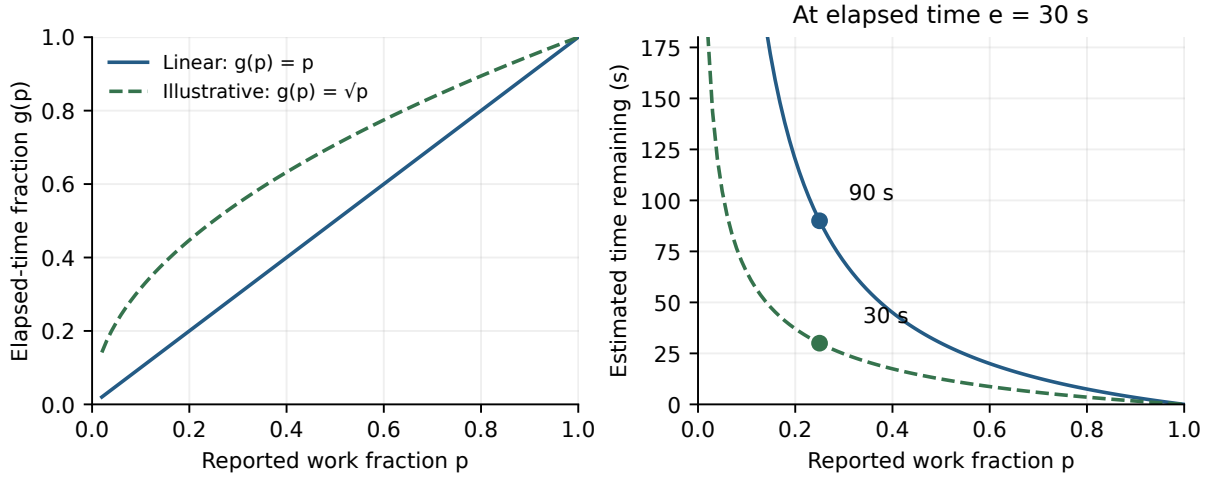


Figure 6: Illustrative progress mappings, not fitted experimental curves. Left: reported work fraction can differ from elapsed-time fraction. Right: with a fresh report at elapsed time 30 s and reported progress 0.25, the linear assumption predicts 90 s remaining; the illustrative square-root curve predicts 30 s. The discrepancy motivates learning tool-specific mappings.

3.3 Aggregation and calibration

The demand board draws Monte Carlo return times and next-call sizes, then sums their contributions using Equation (1). It models one level of child-session fan-out and a Poisson process for exogenous arrivals. The arrival rate is estimated from recent session starts; first-call sizes are sampled from training data. History-only predictors receive a realized demand window only after its full horizon has elapsed, preventing future-window leakage.

Formally, for draw $m = 1, \dots, M$, the board computes

$$D_c^{(m)}(t, h) = \sum_{i \in A_c(t)} \mathbf{1}[R_i^{(m)}(t) \leq h] B_i^{(m)} + U_c^{(m)}(t, h), \quad (6)$$

$$\hat{F}_{c,t,h}(d) = \frac{1}{M} \sum_{m=1}^M \mathbf{1}[D_c^{(m)}(t, h) \leq d], \quad \hat{q}_\tau = \inf\{d : \hat{F}_{c,t,h}(d) \geq \tau\}. \quad (7)$$

The superscript (m) identifies a sampled scenario, d is a candidate block demand, and $\hat{q}_\tau$ is the empirical demand quantile. Quantiles are taken over fleet sums, rather than summing per-session quantiles. For the exogenous part alone, the model draws $N_h \sim \text{Poisson}(\hat{\lambda}h)$ new sessions and sums N_h sampled first-call sizes; $\hat{\lambda}$ is the estimated start rate in sessions per second. Child-session demand is modeled separately within $U_c^{(m)}$.

Forecast dispersion can be calibrated by fitting a variance-inflation factor separately for each class and horizon on a held-out portion of the training data. Calibration uses an overlaid fleet at the evaluation arrival rate. This adjustment changes interval width, but it does not guarantee calibration under model bias, dependence between sessions, or workload shift. M3 is implemented but is not a basis for the main claims: an earlier synthetic slowdown experiment showed inconsistent gains across horizons.

4 System and Admission Policy

A demand distribution becomes operational only when it changes a decision. This section follows that path from sidecar observation to proxy admission, then makes explicit the capacity approximation used by the evaluated hold rule. The distinction between prediction and control will be important when interpreting the cap ablation.

4.1 Architecture and prototype

Figure 7 separates the request path from the measurement and control path. The sidecar observes tool output and emits structured events while preserving the subprocess result. The demand board consumes events and publishes forecast samples. The proxy maintains an admission window and applies ordering and hold decisions before forwarding requests to the serving engine. The Python prototype includes in-memory and JSONL event buses, a FastAPI proxy, a live board, corpus adapters, and a discrete-event simulator. Durable event transport, explicit hardware KV tier placement, and replica-floor control remain architectural extensions; simulator-only eviction ordering is implemented but not evaluated in this report.

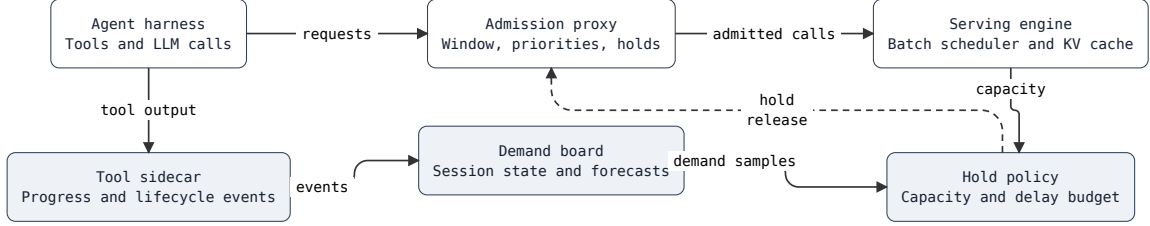


Figure 7: ATFM’s logical architecture. The upper row carries model requests; the lower row carries tool state, forecasts, and capacity information. The dashed connection denotes control of admission. The simulator exercises the feedback loop; the Dynamo Mocker experiment verifies request integration rather than real-GPU capacity feedback.

The sidecar parses build percentages, test counters, generic work counters, and output-rate signals. Parser and event-publication failures are handled without changing tool output. The proxy accepts external hold directives and falls back to default predictions if the prediction service fails; this does not imply that an unavailable serving backend can be bypassed. The recorded Mocker test exercised three concurrent scripted sessions, a two-request admission window, and deadline-sensitive priority hints. It did not measure GPU memory behavior, model quality, or end-to-end controller effectiveness on hardware.

4.2 Ordering and admission

A global window bounds requests released to the engine. Waiting calls are ordered first by class and deadline tier, then by an index. Interactive calls receive tier 1, or tier 2 when estimated deadline slack is below a threshold; background calls receive tier 0. Within a tier, the index is

$$\pi_i = \frac{w_{c(i)} (1 + \beta \mathbb{E}[T_{next,i}])}{\mathbb{E}[S_i]}, \quad (8)$$

where $w_{c(i)}$ is the class weight, S_i is model service time, and $T_{next,i}$ is the next tool duration. The coefficient β controls the preference for serving sessions that will subsequently spend time outside the engine. Service time is estimated from prompt and output lengths using configured prefill and decode rates. Rules-only admission sets the next-tool term to zero. This index is a heuristic, not a Gittins-index solution or an optimal scheduling policy.

4.3 Forecast-based holds and their costs

The GDP-lite policy consults a 30-second forecast slot when a background call becomes eligible for admission. It holds the call if either the 0.9 quantile of interactive KV demand exceeds capacity not occupied by running requests, or an approximation to average interactive batch occupancy exceeds free batch slots. The occupancy approximation divides forecast prompt tokens by mean prompt size to estimate call count, then multiplies by expected service time and divides by slot duration. These tests approximate resource pressure; neither directly enforces a probabilistic bound on actual simultaneous occupancy.

Let $K_f(t)$ and $C_f(t)$ be currently free KV blocks and batch slots, $\bar{L}$ the estimated mean interactive prompt size, and $\bar{S}$ the estimated mean interactive model-service time. For slot length $h_s = 30$ seconds, the evaluated rule can be written as

$$\widehat{O}(t) = \frac{q_{0.9}(D_{\text{int}}^{\text{tok}}(t, h_s))}{\max(\bar{L}, 1)} \frac{\bar{S}}{h_s}, \quad (9)$$

$$H(t) = \mathbf{1} \left[q_{0.9}(D_{\text{int}}^{\text{KV}}(t, h_s)) > K_f(t) \vee \widehat{O}(t) > C_f(t) \right]. \quad (10)$$

The subscript int denotes interactive sessions, D^{tok} is the prompt-token target, $q_{0.9}$ is its forecast 90th percentile, and $H(t) = 1$ requests a background hold subject to its cap. $\widehat{O}$ has units of average occupied batch slots. The numerator estimates call volume over the entire slot, whereas the free-capacity terms are instantaneous. This temporal mismatch explains why a persistently busy engine can trigger holds even when forecast refinements would not change the decision. Equation (10) describes the original rule; Section 6.6 evaluates a capacity-release revision.

Holds are reconsidered at expiry and capped relative to request arrival. Expiration of the policy hold does not bypass the admission window, so ordinary queueing can continue after the cap. The simulator separately records policy-hold duration, ordinary queueing, held-cache occupancy integrated over time, displacement evictions, and prefix recomputation. A delay limit consequently bounds imposed hold time, not total request latency or session completion time.

The completed loaded experiment uses a 600-second hold cap. The long-interactive-tool experiment uses 60 seconds. Where the admission window equals engine batch capacity, the window-based arms place their backlog at the proxy. The native arm queues at the engine. This queue placement is part of the treatment, and results do not isolate the effect of engine-side priority hints.

5 Experimental Methodology

The evaluation separates three links in the argument. H1a tests fleet forecasts using held-out session traces; H1b tests remaining-time predictions using instrumented tools; H2 tests the consequences of changing admission in a closed loop. These experiments answer different questions: a low forecasting loss does not by itself establish a beneficial serving policy.

5.1 Data and splits

Table 3: Data sources and evaluation units. Corpus counts describe the repository’s recorded input snapshot rather than a guarantee about current upstream releases.

Source	Recorded size	Evaluation protocol
TraceLab [7]	4,265 sessions; approximately 357,000 model steps	H1a: 30% of calendar-week blocks held out; test sessions overlaid as a Poisson fleet.
AgentX [8]	393 root sessions; 1,697 sub-agent groups	H1a: 30% of session families held out; roots and children split and shifted together.
Instrumented tools	202 observation points per model across nine scored job families	H1b: one job family held out at a time; real builds, pipelines, and NumPy tests.
Synthetic programs	Five base configurations plus two rule revisions; three seeds each	H2: one hour of new-session arrivals, followed by completion; matched programs across policy arms.

H1a uses arrival rates of 100, 200, and 400 sessions per hour, four-hour overlay windows, 30-second forecast ticks, 256 Monte Carlo samples, and horizons of 10, 30, 120, 300, and 900 seconds. The seed controls splitting and overlay generation. Both public corpora are assigned to the interactive class by

their adapters, so these measurements are not evidence for forecast accuracy across independently labeled interactive and background populations.

TraceLab’s adapter aggregates tools launched by a model step into one phase and uses the longest tool to label that phase. AgentX’s inter-request gaps are not individually labeled as tool or human time; they are represented as generic gaps unless associated with a sub-agent group. Keeping families together prevents related root and child traces from crossing the train/test boundary, but Poisson overlays do not preserve production arrival correlations.

H1b scores observations every 15 seconds within tool phases longer than 30 seconds. A job family is defined by the collection job name, so the same tool at other sizes or rates may remain in training. The retained score file contains nine families: two fmt build variants, four linear pipelines, two staged pipelines, and the NumPy suite. All observations in a held-out family are scored using models trained on the remaining families. Results are averaged over observation points; long phases therefore receive more weight, and the 202 points are not independent experimental replicates.

5.2 Forecast metrics

The primary forecast metric is pinball loss at quantile $\tau = 0.9$, with supplementary continuous ranked probability score (CRPS) and interval coverage [9]. For observation y and predicted quantile q_τ ,

$$\ell_\tau(y, q_\tau) = (\tau - \mathbf{1}[y < q_\tau])(y - q_\tau). \quad (11)$$

An equal-magnitude underprediction receives nine times the penalty of an overprediction at this quantile. Scores retain the target’s units: KV blocks for H1a and seconds for H1b. A loss ratio describes improvement in this score, not a speedup or a corresponding reduction in mean absolute error. H1a sweep ratios divide the mean B1 loss by the mean M1 loss across seeds, rather than averaging per-seed ratios.

CRPS evaluates the full predictive distribution F , rather than one quantile:

$$\text{CRPS}(F, y) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (F(z) - \mathbf{1}[y \leq z])^2 dz. \quad (12)$$

Here z ranges over possible target values, and $F(z)$ is their predicted cumulative probability. Lower CRPS is better. For N evaluated forecasts, empirical central 90% coverage is

$$\widehat{C}_{90} = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=1}^N \mathbf{1}[q_{0.05,k} \leq y_k \leq q_{0.95,k}], \quad (13)$$

where k indexes forecast–observation pairs. Coverage measures interval reliability; wide intervals can cover well while remaining uninformative, so it is read alongside loss.

5.3 Closed-loop workloads and baselines

The simulator advances each program’s next turn after completion of its previous inference and tool execution. It models a block-based least-recently-used cache, prefix reuse, a batch limit, priority order, and fixed prefill/decode rates of 20,000 and 40 tokens per second, respectively. Training programs use an independent seed offset of 1,000 and are run under the native policy. Forecast policies use 128 samples and horizons of 30, 120, and 300 seconds.

Background programs have a mean of ten turns and a 1,800-second deadline. In the long-tool regimes, tool durations are lognormal, with medians of 3 seconds for shell commands, 180 seconds for test suites, and 400 seconds for builds. Their selection probabilities are 0.5, 0.3, and 0.2. Test suites expose strong progress signals and have a 0.05 spawn probability; builds expose weak signals. The short-tool regime uses shell commands and tests with medians of 2 and 20 seconds. Interactive programs have a mean of six

Table 4: Completed simulator configurations. Rates are new sessions per hour; KV capacity is in 16-token blocks. Long/short refers to background tools unless stated otherwise.

Regime	Interactive / background rate	KV / batch / window	Hold cap (s)
Long tools	120 / 240	8,000 / 8 / 8	600
Short tools	120 / 240	8,000 / 8 / 8	600
Loaded long tools	360 / 600	6,000 / 6 / 6	600
Long interactive tools	300 / 480	6,000 / 6 / 6	60
Loaded long tools, cap ablation	360 / 600	6,000 / 6 / 6	60

turns and a lognormal think-time distribution with median 20 seconds. The long-interactive regime adds 120-second tests and 300-second builds to that class.

Seven arms are evaluated in the first three regimes: *native* engine priority, *rules* with a proxy window and index, *forecast M1*, *forecast M2*, *M2 without holds*, *heap lookahead*, and a *working-set* policy. The working-set policy pauses background programs and evicts their cached state when occupancy exceeds a budget, resuming with hysteresis. The long-interactive experiment adds *same-rule lookahead*, which feeds demand inferred from the current event heap into GDP-lite. Both lookahead arms also use actual next-tool durations in the index. They are diagnostic comparisons, not optimal oracles: the heap does not enumerate all future events that policy decisions may induce, and the information and index differences prevent a clean attribution solely to forecast error.

5.4 Serving metrics and uncertainty

Time to first token (TTFT) is measured from request arrival for interactive calls after the initial turn. For each interactive session, the evaluator computes the fraction of these calls with TTFT at most two seconds; *session-weighted SLO attainment* is the mean of these fractions. It is not the fraction of sessions for which every call meets the target. Background job completion time (JCT) is measured from session start to end. Deadline attainment and recomputed prompt tokens quantify additional costs.

In notation, let $\mathcal{J}$ be the evaluated interactive sessions, n_j the number of eligible post-initial calls in session j , and ℓ_{jk} their TTFT values. Then

$$\text{SLO} = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{J}|} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{J}} \frac{1}{n_j} \sum_{k=1}^{n_j} \mathbf{1}[\ell_{jk} \leq 2 \text{ s}], \quad \overline{\text{JCT}} = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{B}|} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{B}} (f_j - a_j), \quad (14)$$

where $\mathcal{B}$ is the evaluated background-session set and a_j, f_j are session start and finish times. Sessions with no eligible post-initial call are excluded from $\mathcal{J}$. This weighting gives each included interactive session equal influence, even when sessions have different numbers of calls. An SLO difference of 0.01 corresponds to one percentage point.

Arms share generated programs and seeds. The reported 95% intervals use 300 paired bootstrap draws over common session identifiers pooled across three seeds. Difference estimates are means of the bootstrap differences; they may differ slightly from subtraction of the displayed point estimates. These intervals reflect variability among sampled sessions under the selected workloads. They do not account fully for dependence between sessions sharing a queue, uncertainty across workload families, or simulator error. No claim of statistical equivalence follows from an interval containing zero.

6 Results

We first ask whether the observable state improves the forecast, then whether progress adds information, and finally whether a policy can use that information profitably. The subsequent comparisons stress the policy by changing the workload, changing only the hold cap, and revising the capacity estimate.

6.1 H1a: in-flight state improves medium-horizon forecasts

Table 5 presents the original TraceLab run at 200 sessions per hour. M1’s q90 pinball loss is lower than B1’s at horizons from 30 seconds through 15 minutes, while B1 performs better at 10 seconds. At five minutes, the B1/M1 ratio is 2.15; at fifteen minutes it is 3.39. M2’s small numerical differences from M1 are attributable to sampling because the corpus supplies no live progress observations.

Table 5: TraceLab, seed 0, 200 sessions/hour. Mean q90 pinball loss of first-resumption KV demand, in blocks; lower is better. Source: the original H1 run, not the three-seed aggregate.

Model	10 s	30 s	2 min	5 min	15 min
B0 persistence	10,409	10,845	13,861	16,485	43,105
B1 Kalman	4,588	6,615	10,597	14,186	26,101
B2 history	40,651	38,324	33,861	30,628	26,183
M1 survival	5,567	5,254	5,679	6,604	7,700
M2 progress	5,538	5,251	5,654	6,611	7,671

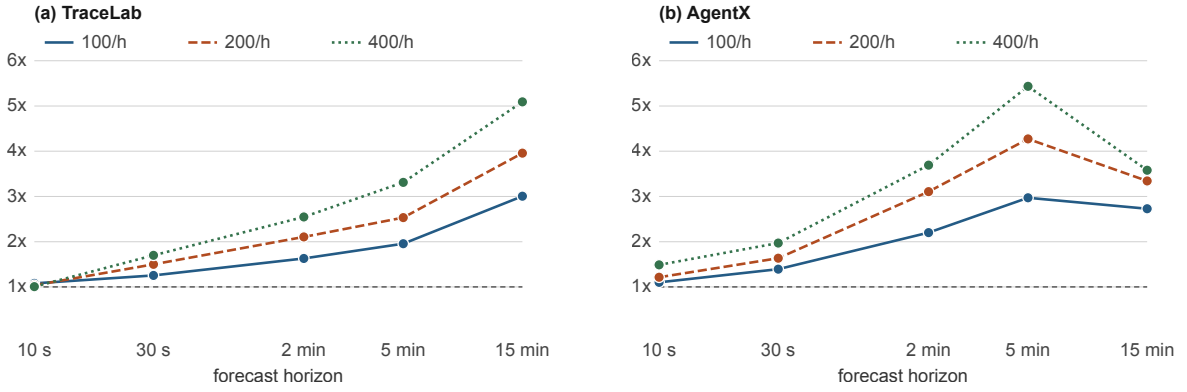


Figure 8: H1a sweep: ratio of mean B1 loss to mean M1 loss across seeds 0-2, at three overlay arrival rates. Ratios above one favor M1. The horizontal axis is logarithmic; line styles also distinguish rates. These are point estimates, with no confidence interval for the ratio. The near-unity TraceLab values at 10 seconds do not imply consistent improvement on individual seeds.

Across the sweep, ratios at five minutes range from 1.96 to 3.31 on TraceLab and from 2.97 to 5.43 on AgentX (Figure 8). At fifteen minutes, the ranges are 3.00-5.09 and 2.73-3.58, respectively. AgentX’s advantage therefore does not increase monotonically with horizon. Three seeds provide limited precision: the stored normal-approximation interval half-widths for M1’s fifteen-minute AgentX loss are approximately 51-63% of its mean. These intervals describe the component loss, not the plotted ratio.

The recorded TraceLab analysis attributes 81-99% of demand to sessions already in flight over the tested horizons, consistent with the opportunity for session-aware forecasting. However, nominal 90% intervals from the session model cover only approximately 40-73% of observations. Training-only dispersion calibration increases coverage to approximately 65-86% and worsens short-horizon pinball loss in the recorded calibration run. Residual bias, dependence, and distribution shift are plausible explanations; these results do not identify which mechanism dominates. B2 performs poorly in the heterogeneous fleet experiments, supporting survival conditioning for this predictor rather than establishing the inferiority of every TTL-based cache policy.

Figure 9 shows why the loss gains do not establish a calibrated probability model. Increasing dispersion moves coverage toward its nominal level, but can worsen the decision-relevant upper-quantile score. The next experiment isolates a different information source: observations of the work a tool has actually completed.

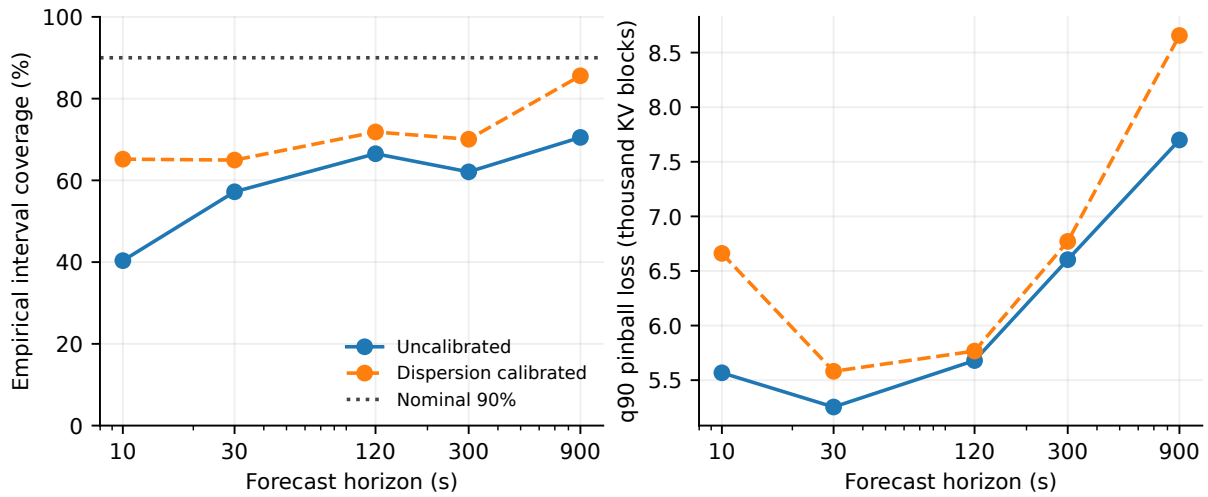


Figure 9: Accuracy and calibration must be checked separately. TraceLab at 200 sessions/hour: M1 before and after training-only dispersion calibration, using the retained original and calibrated runs. Left: central 90% interval coverage versus its nominal target. Right: q90 pinball loss. These are descriptive run-level summaries, without cross-seed uncertainty estimates.

6.2 H1b: progress helps, but depends on the tool's progress curve

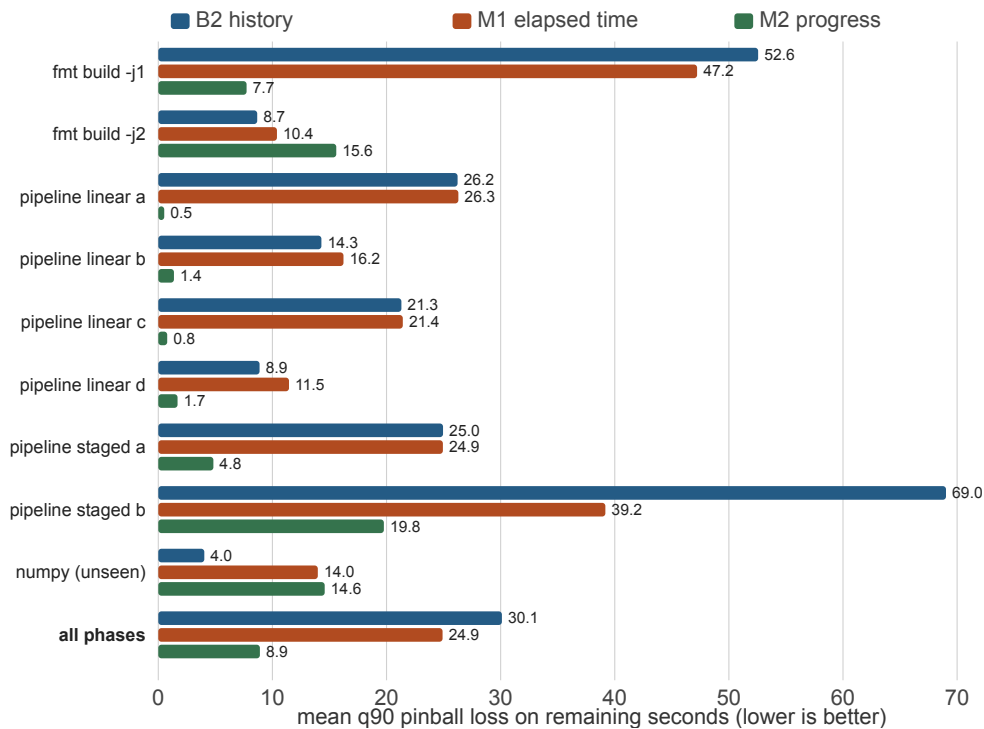


Figure 10: Leave-one-job-family-out remaining-time evaluation. Bars show mean q90 pinball loss in seconds; lower is better. The aggregate weights all 202 observation points equally. The NumPy family is unseen in training for its displayed row. Bars are descriptive averages, not estimates from independent observations with uncertainty bars.

Across the retained collection, M2 reduces mean q90 pinball loss from M1's 24.9 to 8.9 seconds, a 2.80-fold loss ratio (64% reduction). CRPS decreases from 59.0 to 30.1 seconds, a 1.96-fold ratio. The larger CRPS ratio of 3.4 recorded for an earlier pipeline/build-only collection does not apply to the expanded collection shown here.

Progress is most informative for the linear pipelines, whose M2 losses range from 0.5 to 1.7 seconds. It remains useful with four stage markers, but is not uniformly beneficial: M2 loses to M1 for the fmt - j2

build and the held-out NumPy suite. Reported work fractions can map nonlinearly to elapsed time, and a curve learned from a different build configuration can be misleading. A separate one-prior-run NumPy analysis in the research notes reports CRPS of 18.8 seconds for M2 versus 53.7 for M1; that is a different training protocol and is not pooled into Figure 10.

The results support the value of progress on the measured jobs, not on arbitrary external actions. The sample contains nine scored families on one machine, with repeated observations within phases and limited environmental variation. The current implementation can key progress curves by command signature, but the retained score file predates evaluation of that change. Its results must not be attributed to the newer signature-aware implementation.

6.3 H2: loaded short-interactive workloads show a latency-cost trade-off

We now turn from prediction to action. Figure 11 places the five base configurations on common outcome axes. Large gains occur in the loaded 600-second-cap configuration; the remaining configurations expose either little headroom for improvement or an unfavorable background cost. The following subsections examine these cases rather than averaging unlike workloads together.

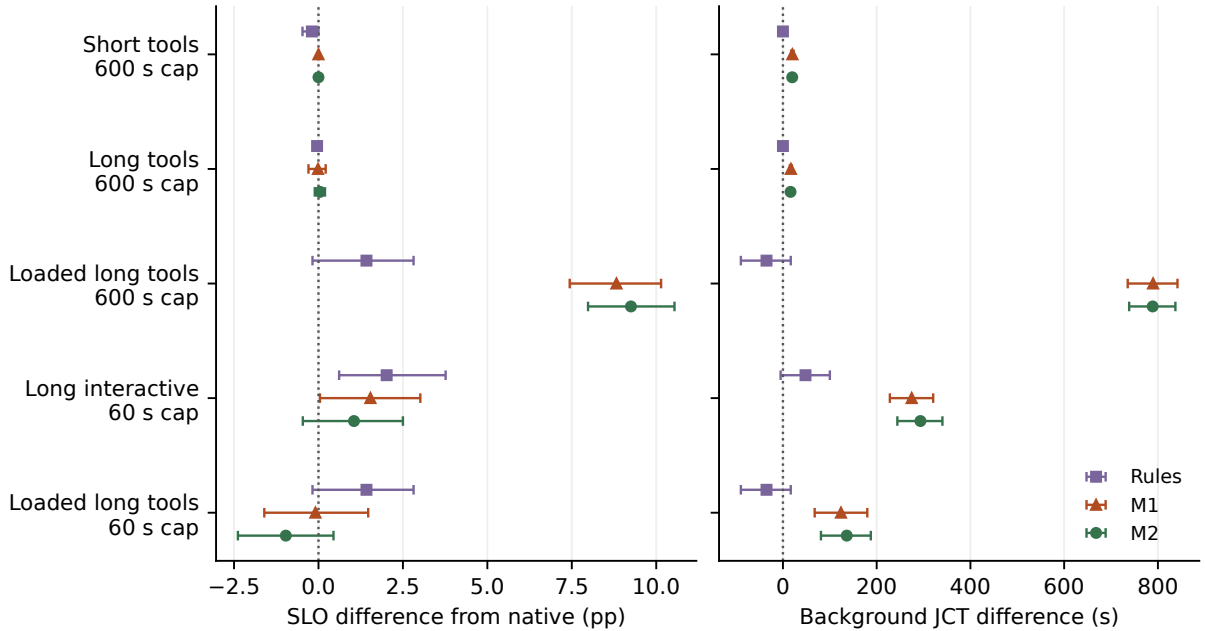


Figure 11: Policy effects across the five base configurations. Points show paired differences from native; lines are 95% session-bootstrap intervals. Positive SLO differences are benefits; positive background JCT differences are costs. Rows denote separate workloads except the two loaded-long-tool rows, which share the workload and vary the cap. Intervals pool sessions across three seeds and do not measure uncertainty across workload families.

In the loaded long-tool regime, interactive sessions still execute short shell tools. Forecast M2 raises session-weighted SLO attainment from 85.3% to 94.6% (Table 6). Its paired improvement is 9.3 percentage points, with a 95% session-bootstrap interval of 8.0-10.5 points. Mean background JCT rises from 3,310 to 4,100 seconds, approximately 24%. The corresponding bootstrap estimate of the difference is 789 seconds [739, 837].

Removing holds from M2 eliminates the observed SLO gain over native in this regime. This supports a role for the hold mechanism in the measured trade-off; it does not prove that the particular forecast is necessary or that another hold heuristic could not obtain a similar result. M1 and M2 produce similar point estimates because the hold rule targets interactive demand over 30 seconds, while the distinctive long progress-emitting tools are in the background class.

The working-set arm reaches 92.9% SLO attainment and adds 2,082 seconds of background JCT. Its

Table 6: Loaded long-tool regime, three seeds. SLO is session-weighted attainment (%); Δ SLO is in percentage points. JCT is mean background completion time (s). Brackets are paired 95% session-bootstrap intervals.

Arm	SLO (%)	Δ SLO [95% interval]	JCT (s)	Δ JCT [95% interval]
Native	85.3	-	3,310	-
Rules	86.7	+1.4 [-0.2, +2.8]	3,278	-35 [-90, +17]
Forecast M1	94.1	+8.8 [+7.4, +10.1]	4,101	+790 [+736, +842]
Forecast M2	94.6	+9.3 [+8.0, +10.5]	4,100	+789 [+739, +837]
M2, no holds	84.1	-1.3 [-2.8, +0.1]	3,277	-35 [-97, +10]
Heap lookahead	92.3	+7.0 [+5.4, +8.3]	4,453	+1141 [+1090, +1190]
Working set	92.9	+7.6 [+6.3, +8.9]	5,392	+2082 [+2035, +2136]

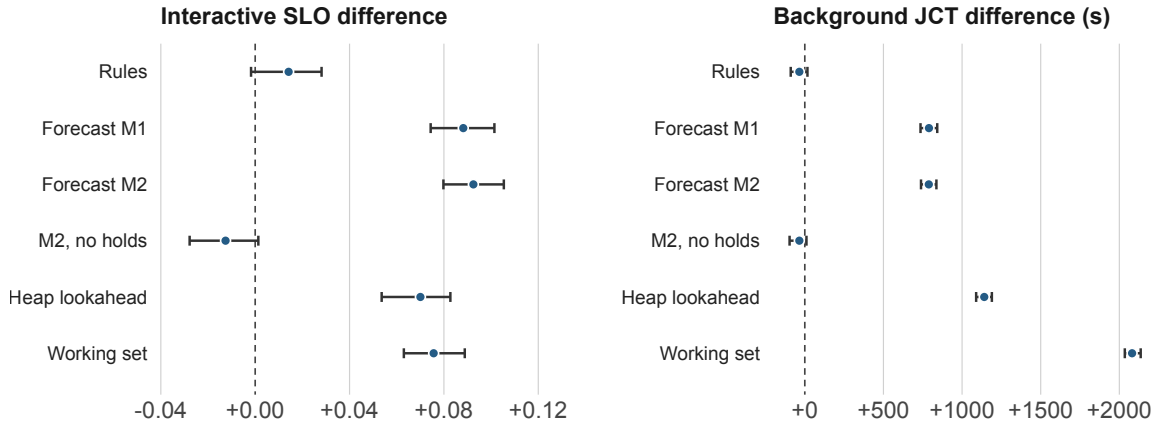


Figure 12: Paired differences from native in the loaded regime. Left: session-weighted SLO difference on the 0-1 scale. Right: mean background JCT difference in seconds. Points are bootstrap mean differences; lines are 95% session-bootstrap intervals. Positive SLO differences are beneficial; positive JCT differences are costs.

incremental background cost is approximately 2.64 times that of M2, but the SLO outcomes are not identical. This is a comparison between local policies under one simulator configuration, not a claim of superiority over ThunderAgent. Neither lookahead nor working-set results provide an optimal policy bound.

Costs extend beyond JCT. Forecast M2 reduces background deadline attainment from 19.0% to 12.2%, accumulates approximately 4.20 million held KV block-seconds per seed, and reaches the hold cap on approximately 1,193 occasions per seed (Appendix B). Its recomputed prefill volume is lower than native’s in this loaded regime. In the underloaded long- and short-tool regimes, near-saturated SLO attainment limits discrimination: forecast M2 adds about 16 and 20 seconds to background JCT, respectively, for little change in the SLO metric. Lower request latency is not sufficient evidence of a favorable overall policy trade-off.

6.4 Long interactive tools do not establish an M2 policy advantage

The completed long-interactive-tool experiment adds progress-emitting tests and builds to interactive sessions and uses a 60-second cap. It also changes arrival rates to 300 interactive and 480 background sessions per hour. It is therefore a separate regime, not a controlled hold-cap ablation. Table 7 includes all eight arms, including the same-rule lookahead comparison.

M2’s SLO improvement over native is 1.1 percentage points, with an interval spanning zero (-0.5 to 2.5 points), while its background JCT cost is 293 seconds [244, 340]. Rules-only admission has a higher SLO point estimate, 88.7% versus 87.7%, and a smaller JCT increase of 48 seconds [-5, 100]. M1 also has a higher SLO point estimate than M2. These native-referenced intervals do not directly test M1 against M2, but the results provide no evidence that progress-based forecasting improves this controller’s performance.

Table 7: Long-interactive-tool regime, three seeds, 60-second hold cap. Units and interval construction match Table 6.

Arm	SLO (%)	Δ SLO [95% interval]	JCT (s)	Δ JCT [95% interval]
Native	86.7	-	2,309	-
Rules	88.7	+2.0 [+0.6, +3.8]	2,359	+48 [-5, +100]
Forecast M1	88.2	+1.5 [+0.0, +3.0]	2,585	+275 [+228, +321]
Forecast M2	87.7	+1.1 [-0.5, +2.5]	2,604	+293 [+244, +340]
M2, no holds	86.8	+0.1 [-1.4, +1.7]	2,370	+60 [+16, +115]
Heap lookahead	87.4	+0.8 [-0.7, +2.2]	3,274	+962 [+899, +1031]
Same-rule lookahead	87.7	+1.0 [-0.4, +2.6]	3,315	+1003 [+941, +1075]
Working set	89.3	+2.6 [+1.0, +3.9]	2,921	+611 [+557, +676]

The same-rule lookahead arm reaches 87.7% SLO attainment with approximately 1,003 seconds of additional background JCT. More future information is thus not sufficient for this heuristic to improve the measured trade-off. Policy choice, horizon, and capacity approximation remain material limitations.

6.5 A controlled cap ablation removes the loaded-regime gain

The 60-second-cap run repeats the loaded long-tool regime of Table 6 with the same programs, seeds, engine and rates, changing only the hold cap from 600 to 60 seconds and adding the same-rule lookahead arm. It is the fixed-workload hold-cap ablation that Section 6.4 could not provide.

Figure 13 connects the two cap settings for each policy. The horizontal segments show the joint pattern: reducing deferral lowers background completion time while removing much of the interactive benefit. The plotted points are absolute outcomes; the paired intervals for differences from native remain in Tables 6 and 8.

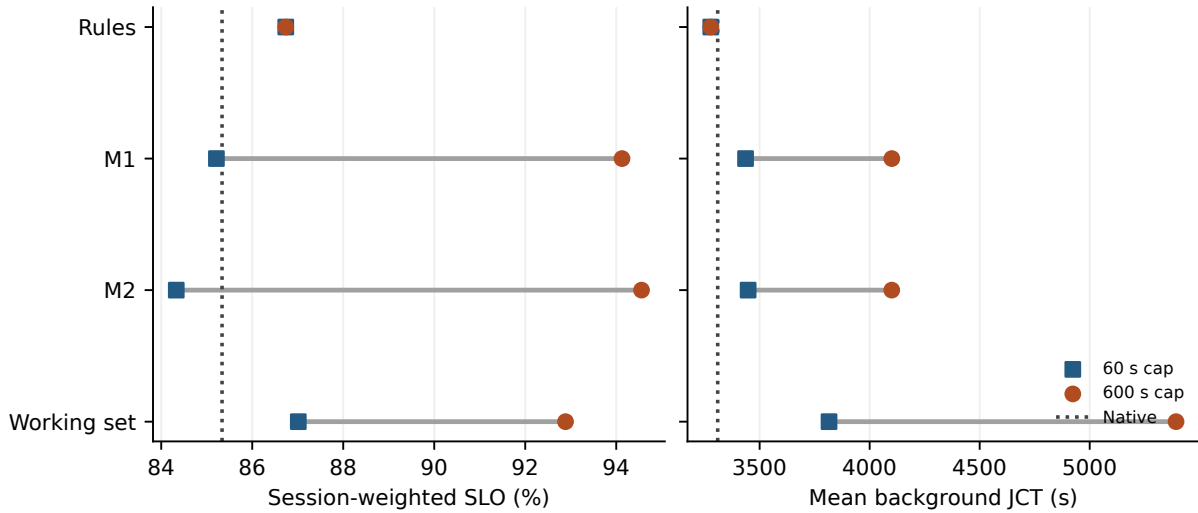


Figure 13: Controlled cap ablation on the loaded long-tool workload. Squares denote a 60 s cap and circles a 600 s cap; connecting segments identify the same policy. The dotted line is native performance, which is unaffected by the cap. Points are retained pooled-session means; no uncertainty for the direct between-cap difference is inferred from this plot.

With the cap at 60 seconds the forecast arms' SLO differences from native are -0.1 and -1.0 percentage points with intervals spanning zero, while their background JCT still rises by 124 seconds [68, 180] and 136 seconds [81, 187], and they accumulate approximately 3.7 million held KV block-seconds per seed with about 2,770 holds reaching the cap. The same-rule lookahead, holding with the true first-resumption demand

Table 8: Loaded long-tool regime at a 60-second hold cap, three seeds. Units and interval construction match Table 6; the native row is the same workload as Table 6 and differs only by bootstrap resampling.

Arm	SLO (%)	Δ SLO [95% interval]	JCT (s)	Δ JCT [95% interval]
Native	85.3	-	3,310	-
Rules	86.7	+1.4 [-0.2, +2.8]	3,278	-35 [-90, +17]
Forecast M1	85.2	-0.1 [-1.6, +1.5]	3,436	+124 [+68, +180]
Forecast M2	84.3	-1.0 [-2.4, +0.4]	3,448	+136 [+81, +187]
M2, no holds	84.1	-1.3 [-2.8, +0.1]	3,277	-35 [-97, +10]
Heap lookahead	85.2	-0.1 [-1.5, +1.3]	4,461	+1150 [+1085, +1213]
Same-rule lookahead	84.2	-1.1 [-2.4, +0.4]	4,474	+1162 [+1099, +1226]
Working set	87.0	+1.7 [+0.2, +3.2]	3,815	+505 [+445, +566]

in hand, changes SLO by -1.1 points [-2.4, +0.4] at a cost of 1,162 seconds [1,099, 1,226]. Rules-only admission is unchanged from Table 6. The working-set arm also responds to the shorter cap: its SLO attainment falls from 92.9% to 87.0%, while mean background JCT falls from 5,392 to 3,815 seconds. The 9.3-point gain of Table 6 therefore depends on allowing much longer deferrals in this experiment. The ablation establishes sensitivity to the cap; without a matched reactive-hold baseline, it does not isolate how much of that gain requires the forecast’s content.

The hold counts also suggest a mechanism consistent with Equation (10): under sustained load, little capacity is free at the instant of a decision, so many positive-demand forecasts can trigger the same hold. Similar M1 and M2 outcomes are consistent with this saturation of the decision rule; the aggregate counts alone do not prove that every decision was forecast-insensitive. A revised rule that counts capacity expected to free within the slot has also been evaluated; Section 6.6 reports the completed reruns. At the intended 60-second cap, neither loaded workload establishes a benefit for M2 over native. These findings motivate revising the capacity comparison and testing other uses of the forecast, including KV placement, rather than concluding that predictive admission cannot work.

6.6 Revised capacity accounting reduces cost without establishing an SLO gain

GDP-lite v2 augments the instantaneous free-capacity terms in Equation (10) with the blocks and slots held by running requests estimated to finish within the forecast slot. Forecast arms estimate completion from start time plus expected service time; the same-rule lookahead uses actual scheduled completion. The same loaded and long-interactive programs were rerun at a 60-second cap. This change improves the alignment of the capacity horizon, although it still does not represent a full occupancy trajectory.

Table 9: GDP-lite v2 at a 60-second hold cap, three seeds per workload. Paired differences from native and 95% session-bootstrap intervals. SLO differences are percentage points; JCT differences are seconds.

Arm	Δ SLO [95% interval]	Δ background JCT [95% interval]
<i>Loaded long tools</i>		
Forecast M1	-1.3 [-2.9, +0.2]	+3 [-52, +49]
Forecast M2	-0.2 [-1.7, +1.1]	+7 [-52, +62]
Same-rule lookahead	-1.8 [-3.5, -0.3]	+1111 [+1042, +1178]
<i>Long interactive tools</i>		
Forecast M1	+0.1 [-1.5, +1.5]	+73 [+28, +119]
Forecast M2	+0.8 [-0.8, +2.3]	+83 [+41, +133]
Same-rule lookahead	-0.4 [-2.0, +1.5]	+878 [+822, +948]

In the loaded workload, M1 and M2 now add only about 3 and 7 seconds of background JCT, with intervals spanning zero. In the long-interactive workload, their costs fall to 73 and 83 seconds, respectively.

SLO intervals still span zero in both workloads (Table 9). The revision therefore reduces the cost of the original rule without establishing a forecast-policy benefit over native; these intervals do not establish equivalence.

The lookahead result points to a separate attribution problem. It reaches the cap only about 10 times per seed in the loaded workload and 95 times in the long-interactive workload, yet adds 1,111 and 878 seconds of background JCT. Its use of actual next-tool duration in the ordering index is a candidate explanation. The aggregate results motivate the no-index diagnostic in Section 8; they do not by themselves quantify the causal contribution of that index. This finding reinforces the need to vary forecast information, hold logic, and priority ordering independently.

7 Discussion and Limitations

Taken together, the figures identify two different boundaries. Session state and progress can reduce predictive loss, but imperfect calibration limits probabilistic interpretation. Admission then adds a second boundary: a forecast must be compared with a capacity model that matches its target and horizon. The limitations below follow these two boundaries from measurement through deployment.

Simulation validity. No reported policy experiment runs on a real GPU. The engine model omits important effects of actual kernels, batching, memory movement, and interconnects. Fixed service rates and simplified cache eviction can affect even the relative ordering of policies. The simulator’s metadata exposes the programmed output length to service-time estimation, which further simplifies deployment uncertainty. Mock integration establishes request-path compatibility only.

Target-to-control mismatch. First-resumption KV demand is not simultaneous memory occupancy, and input-token demand is not uncached prefill work. Comparing these quantities with available capacity is a useful heuristic to study, but forecast calibration alone cannot validate that comparison. Repeated turns, cache sharing, backend interference, and multi-level fan-out require richer models. The present forecaster models only one level of fan-out.

External validity and uncertainty. Poisson-overlaid traces preserve within-session timing while changing fleet-level arrivals. Both public corpora represent coding agents, and AgentX gaps mix tool and human delays. Tool collections favor observable, parseable progress and do not cover silent tools, network services, or human actions broadly. Three seeds, dependent sessions in shared queues, and repeated H1b observations limit uncertainty estimates. The confidence intervals should not be interpreted as population-level guarantees.

Baseline scope and attribution. The study compares selected local baselines with particular parameter settings, without broad controller tuning or a matched reactive-hold baseline. B2 is an information ablation, not Continuum. The working-set arm is inspired by program pausing, not a faithful ThunderAgent implementation. The no-hold ablation measures the effect of holds within M2; it cannot isolate the value of the forecast from all alternative hold strategies. The event-heap lookahead arms neither optimize a common objective nor reveal all counterfactual future arrivals.

Required validation. A hardware study should compare native priority, rules, forecast policies, matched reactive holds, and published implementations on a common workload, reporting latency, completion time, task quality, and cache costs. The repository proposes a two-H100 Dynamo setup with instrumented background tools and interactive agents. Before such a study, paired simulation/hardware calibration, more seeds, signature-aware progress evaluation, and direct attribution of forecast and index effects would clarify which findings transfer. Both the fixed-workload cap ablation and revised-rule reruns have been completed (Sections 6.5–6.6). Section 8 specifies the remaining validation and deployment work.

8 Future Work and Technical Validation Plan

The experiments establish an information advantage more clearly than a control advantage. The next phase must therefore identify which decisions are sensitive to that information before extending deployment scale. Figure 14 orders the main dependencies. This section distinguishes implemented mechanisms awaiting evaluation from proposed extensions; the latter equations specify candidate designs, not algorithms validated by the reported results.

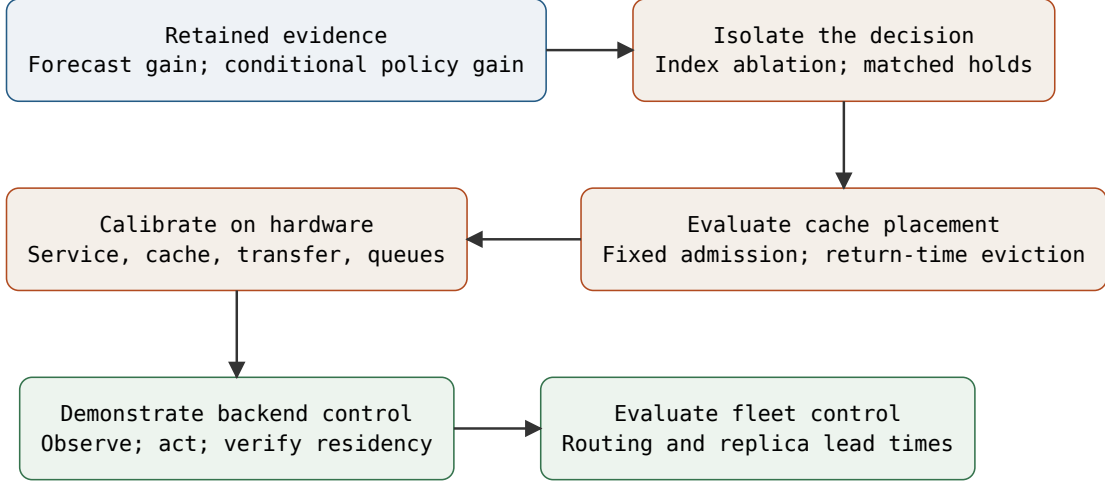


Figure 14: Technical dependencies for the remaining study. Controller attribution and cache-policy evaluation precede claims about hardware benefit. Explicit tier placement requires verified backend control; fleet-level replica experiments additionally require measured capacity and provisioning lead times. Forecast calibration and workload expansion apply throughout.

8.1 Isolate forecast value from admission and ordering

GDP-lite v2 and its two completed reruns are reported in Section 6.6; repeating the original cap ablation is no longer the next step. The outstanding attribution experiment is the implemented `oracle_rule_noidx` arm, configured in `experiments/h2sim_interactive_long_idx.yaml`. It retains the same-rule lookahead hold decision while setting the next-tool contribution in Equation (8) to zero. Pairing it with `oracle_rule` on identical programs isolates the ordering change more closely than comparing either with native. Completion time, deadline attainment, per-session wait, and the distribution of consecutive bypasses should be recorded to test whether the exact-duration index disadvantages particular background programs. No completed score for this diagnostic is included in the present artifact.

A second required control is a reactive policy matched to the forecast policy’s imposed-delay budget. Candidate policies should share class tiers, admission window, cap, and engine placement, while varying only the signal used to trigger holds. Matching mean hold time alone is insufficient: report its distribution, the number of distinct sessions delayed, held KV, and queueing after cap expiry. Sweep the cap and index coefficient β on training workloads, then lock them for evaluation. Compare policies at common background-cost budgets rather than selecting a favorable latency point after observing the test results.

For two policies a, b , a direct paired effect for per-session outcome Y_j is

$$\hat{\Delta}_{a,b} = \frac{1}{|\mathcal{J}_{ab}|} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{J}_{ab}} (Y_j^a - Y_j^b), \quad (15)$$

where $\mathcal{J}_{ab}$ contains session identifiers present in both arms. Outcomes should be chosen separately for

interactive attainment and background JCT. More independent workload seeds are needed; a hierarchical analysis can resample seeds first and whole session families within seeds. This would address more sources of variation than the current pooled-session bootstrap, although shared-queue dependence still requires care.

8.2 Align predicted demand with time-varying capacity

The v2 capacity-release estimate reduces unnecessary holds, but adding capacity freed during a slot still does not model the timing of arrivals and departures within it. A stronger controller needs occupancy trajectories rather than only cumulative first-return demand. One proposed representation is

$$O_r^{(m)}(u) = O_{r,0}^{(m)}(u) + \sum_k a_{kr}^{(m)} \mathbf{1}[A_k^{(m)} \leq u < F_k^{(m)}], \quad u \in [t, t+h], \quad (16)$$

where r identifies a resource, m a sampled future, $O_{r,0}$ the remaining occupancy of work already running, and A_k, F_k, a_{kr} the admission time, release time, and resource use of future request k . For batch slots, $a_{kr} = 1$; for KV, residency must instead follow allocation, growth, sharing, eviction, and offload events, which can extend beyond request completion. A separate cache-state process is consequently required for memory.

This model must include repeated agent turns, service-time uncertainty, and feedback from the proposed admission schedule. A candidate overload constraint on decision-grid times $\mathcal{G}$ is

$$\frac{1}{M} \sum_{m=1}^M \mathbf{1} \left[\max_{u \in \mathcal{G}} \{O_r^{(m)}(u) - C_r(u)\} > 0 \right] \leq \epsilon_r, \quad (17)$$

where $C_r(u)$ is available resource capacity and ϵ_r an allowed empirical violation fraction. It is a sample-based design constraint, not a guaranteed real-world probability bound. A finite grid can miss between-grid peaks, and miscalibrated samples can understate risk. Validate realized overflow and intervention rates on held-out surges. If constraints are imposed separately on K slots, a per-slot error allowance ϵ provides only the union-bound allowance $K\epsilon$ for any-slot failure; horizon-wide risk must be budgeted explicitly.

8.3 Evaluate return-aware KV eviction and demonstrate tier placement

The repository implements `forecast_M1_kv`, `forecast_M2_kv`, and `oracle_kv` in `src/atfm/sim/kv_placement.py`, with loaded and long-interactive configurations. These arms use rules-only admission and change the eviction order among eligible idle sessions. The forecast versions estimate an absolute return time from the median of finite sampled return times; an unavailable estimate is treated as infinity. The policy evicts the latest predicted return first. This is implemented simulator functionality, but completed results are not included here.

A minimal comparison must hold the request order fixed while comparing LRU, M1, M2, and lookahead eviction. Record prefix tokens recomputed, TTFT after tool return, cache hits, background JCT, and victims per eviction. Vary context size, KV capacity, tool-duration heterogeneity, progress availability, and return-time correlation. The current median-of-finite-samples rule also discards the probability of never returning when at least one finite sample exists; test whether retaining that probability improves decisions. Lookahead provides an information diagnostic, not an optimal cache policy under variable sizes and repeated requests.

Explicit HBM/DRAM/SSD placement is a separate step. First demonstrate that a backend can identify a session's resident prefix, demote or promote it, and verify the resulting residency and resumption cost. Unsupported operations should remain logged advisory directives. Measure transfer latency as a function of prefix size and concurrent transfers; do not assume that bandwidth alone determines completion. For a prefix of size V_i bytes, an initial approximation is

$$\ell_i^{\text{move}} = \ell_0 + \frac{V_i}{B}, \quad t_i^{\text{start}} = t + q_\alpha(R_i(t)) - \ell_i^{\text{move}} - \delta, \quad (18)$$

where ℓ_0 is setup latency, $\widehat{B}$ effective transfer bandwidth in bytes/s, δ a safety margin, and $q_\alpha(R_i(t))$ an early return quantile. A start time already in the past requests immediate action, subject to capacity. Under an accurate continuous return distribution, an early quantile targets roughly an α probability of return before the planned ready time; actual success also depends on transfer uncertainty. Evaluate missed pre-staging deadlines, unused transfers, memory pressure, and interference with model execution before claiming benefit.

8.4 Improve calibration, progress generalization, and event integrity

The signature-aware progress implementation must be evaluated with new held-out collections rather than credited with historical H1b scores. Split by command signature and environment, including build parallelism, input size, cache warmth, and machine load. Retain all observations from a tool execution in one split. Compare M1, pooled M2, signature-aware M2, and online adaptation; report per-family errors and pooled errors so that long jobs do not conceal short-job failures. Silent tools and sparse, stale, reset, or out-of-order counters require explicit fallback tests.

Fleet evaluation should add correlated arrivals, shared-backend slowdowns, multi-level fan-out, and changing fractions of exogenous demand. M3’s shared slowdown factor needs a controlled comparison with the same marginal duration distributions but different cross-session dependence. Calibration should be fitted on disjoint time blocks and assessed by class, horizon, workload, and load regime. Report coverage, interval width, pinball loss, and CRPS together. Track $\Pr(R_i = \infty)$, uncertain tool-output size, and pending gaps separately; widening intervals alone does not correct biased return probabilities.

Deployment also requires validating the event path. The implemented in-memory and JSONL buses should be complemented by a durable deployment transport, with event identifiers, per-session sequence numbers, replay checkpoints, and bounded staleness. Duplicate delivery must not double-count a child or a request; late completion must reconcile stale running state. Measure event-to-forecast lag, missed-event rate, board CPU cost, and memory per active session. Board loss should cause bounded fallback and hold expiry, with no dependence on a fresh forecast to release an expired hold. These checks establish operational behavior; they do not substitute for predictive validation.

8.5 Validate the simulator and controller on GPUs

The repository’s proposed hardware sequence starts with a single GPU to characterize service and cache behavior, then two H100 GPUs for the main study. Two independent replicas permit routing experiments; a model requiring two-way tensor parallelism instead tests a single distributed replica. The deployment choice must therefore follow the question being tested. Freeze model weights, tokenizer, quantization, serving-engine revision, scheduling settings, and trace inputs for every paired comparison.

Replace fixed prefill/decode rates with measured profiles conditioned on prompt length, output length, batch size, and cache-hit fraction. Measure transfer and recomputation separately, and verify whether proxy priority reaches the engine queue. Run paired simulator/hardware cells spanning underload, sustained contention, interactive surges, synchronized tool completions, and worker loss. For metric z , report relative discrepancy

$$E_z = \frac{|z_{\text{sim}} - z_{\text{hardware}}|}{\max(|z_{\text{hardware}}|, \eta_z)}, \quad (19)$$

where $\eta_z > 0$ is a declared, metric-specific small denominator floor. Include mean and tail JCT, post-tool TTFT, cache-miss volume, and the ordering of policy effects; accurate averages alone are inadequate. The project plan proposes a 6% JCT-error target, which is a prospective validation target rather than an achieved result or a universal threshold.

The policy study should include native engine priority, rules-only admission, matched reactive holds, forecast policies, and compatible published implementations under common resource and tuning budgets. Report task success or quality, interactive attainment, background completion and deadlines, GPU-hours, queue location, and cache costs. Preserve paired programs where possible, but also run live agents:

admission delays may change external tool outcomes or agent trajectories in ways fixed trace replay cannot capture.

8.6 Extend to routing and replica control only after calibration

The architecture proposes a planner integration returning a minimum replica floor. This remains future work and should first be exercised with virtual workers. Let ℓ be the measured scale-out lead time, $\widehat{\lambda}_{\text{req}}(t + \ell)$ a forecast request rate at readiness, μ a sustainable per-replica rate for the relevant workload, and $\rho_* < 1$ a target utilization. A first approximation is

$$n_{\min}(t) = \left\lceil \frac{q_{0.9}(\widehat{\lambda}_{\text{req}}(t + \ell))}{\rho_* \mu} \right\rceil. \quad (20)$$

The rate forecast in this equation is an extension of the present first-return target: it must include repeated requests and map their sizes to service demand. Heterogeneous replicas, routing affinity, KV capacity, prefill/decode bottlenecks, and uncertain startup times require a richer feasibility model. Apply warm-up accounting, scale-down hysteresis, and minimum dwell times; otherwise forecast noise can produce oscillation.

Evaluate reactive scaling against the predictive floor at matched SLO or GPU-hour budgets, including cold starts and idle reservations in cost. A hybrid setup with two real workers and additional Mocker workers can test integration and sensitivity at larger logical scale, but cannot establish real multi-node transfer cost or real provisioning lead times. Those claims require physical multi-node experiments. Success at each stage should be a reproducible improvement in the latency–cost trade-off under held-out workloads, not merely a lower forecast loss or a functioning control API.

9 Conclusion

ATFM treats external agent execution as observable state for inference-demand forecasting. Across two coding-agent corpora, elapsed-time conditioning improves medium-horizon first-resumption forecasts over an aggregate-history baseline. Live progress further improves remaining-time scores on selected long-running tools, with identifiable failures when progress curves differ between training and evaluation. Closed-loop results are negative for the admission lever as implemented: forecast-based holds improve interactive SLO attainment only when the cap permits ten-minute deferrals, a controlled cap ablation removes the gain, and true future demand does not restore it, while rules-only admission gives a small consistent gain at little cost. Revised capacity accounting reduces the cost of holds but still does not establish an SLO gain. The principal finding is that session state is useful for forecasting, while converting that information into a favorable serving policy remains workload- and controller-dependent.

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A Artifact and Reproducibility

The editable manuscript is `docs/paper/atfm-paper.tex`, with BibTeX references in `references.bib` and vector PDF figures in `latex-fig/`. Tables and figures retain the values in the frozen CSVs under `docs/paper/results/`. The LaTeX document builds directly with `latexmk`; the optional `build_latex.py` wrapper checks compilation and publishes the PDF. Its `-figures` option refreshes vector figures from the saved result summaries. That directory includes a manifest with original run paths, source hashes, and the repository commit at capture. Raw `data/` and `runs/` directories are ignored by Git, so retaining these summaries makes paper rebuilding independent of locally collected raw traces. It does not by itself reproduce the experiments.

The repository specifies Python 3.12 and locks dependencies with `uv.lock`. The principal implementation paths are `src/atfm/board/` for session models and aggregation, `sidecar/` for tool observation, `proxy/` for admission, `sim/` for closed-loop execution, and `eval/` for scores and bootstrap metrics. Experiment configurations reside in `experiments/`. The architecture specification and dated research notes in `docs/` provide design history; when a narrative note disagrees with retained metrics, this report uses the metric files.

Table A1: Provenance of the main results. Paths are relative to the repository root; the corresponding summaries are frozen with this paper.

Result	Source artifact
H1a original run	<code>runs/h1_tracelab_r200/metrics.csv</code>
H1a sweeps	<code>runs/sweep_tracelab.csv</code> ; <code>runs/sweep_agentx.csv</code>
H1b retained collection	<code>runs/h1b_with_numpy.csv</code> , aggregated by family/model and by model
Loaded H2	<code>runs/h2sim_long_tool_loaded/{metrics,paired}.csv</code>
Long-interactive H2	<code>runs/h2sim_interactive_long/{metrics,paired}.csv</code>
Loaded H2, 60-second cap	<code>runs/h2sim_long_tool_loaded_cap60/{metrics,paired}.csv</code>
GDP-lite v2 reruns	<code>runs/h2sim_interactive_long_v2/{metrics,paired}.csv</code> ; <code>runs/h2sim_long_tool_loaded_cap60_v2/{metrics,paired}.csv</code>

From the repository root, the following commands rebuild the document and show the experiment entry points. Experiment commands require their configured raw inputs and may be expensive; they are distinct from the paper build.

```
python3 docs/paper/build_latex.py
uv run python scripts/run_h1.py experiments/h1_tracelab.yaml
uv run python scripts/sweep_h1.py experiments/h1_agentx.yaml \
  --seeds 0 1 2 --rates 100 200 400 --out runs/sweep_agentx.csv
uv run python scripts/h1b_resumption.py <collection-events.jsonl> \
  --min-duration 30 --offset 15 --out <scores.csv>
uv run python scripts/run_h2sim.py experiments/h2sim_loaded.yaml
uv run python scripts/run_h2sim.py experiments/h2sim_interactive_long.yaml
uv run python scripts/run_h2sim.py experiments/h2sim_loaded_cap60.yaml
uv run python scripts/run_h2sim.py experiments/h2sim_loaded_cap60_v2.yaml
uv run python scripts/run_h2sim.py experiments/h2sim_interactive_long_v2.yaml
```

The reported H1b aggregate combines the earlier build/pipeline collections with NumPy runs; recreating it requires the same collection composition and historical predictor implementation. The current command-signature feature can change rescored values. Earlier exploratory results and integration checks are documented in `docs/research/2026-09-22-h1-first-results.md`, `2026-09-23-h1-second-corpus-and-h1b.md`, `2026-09-23-l1-results.md`, and `2026-09-24-h2sim-first-results.md`. The completed loaded 60-second-cap experiment is reported in Section 6.5; the two completed GDP-lite v2 reruns are reported in Section 6.6. KV-placement and index-diagnostic outcomes remain outside this evidence snapshot.

Writing assistance. Earlier project materials disclosed assistance from Claude Code. This revision used Codex for editorial revision, consistency checks, and document generation; retained experiment summaries are identified above.

B Additional Loaded-Regime Costs

Figure 15 shows the resource costs and their spread across the three seeds.

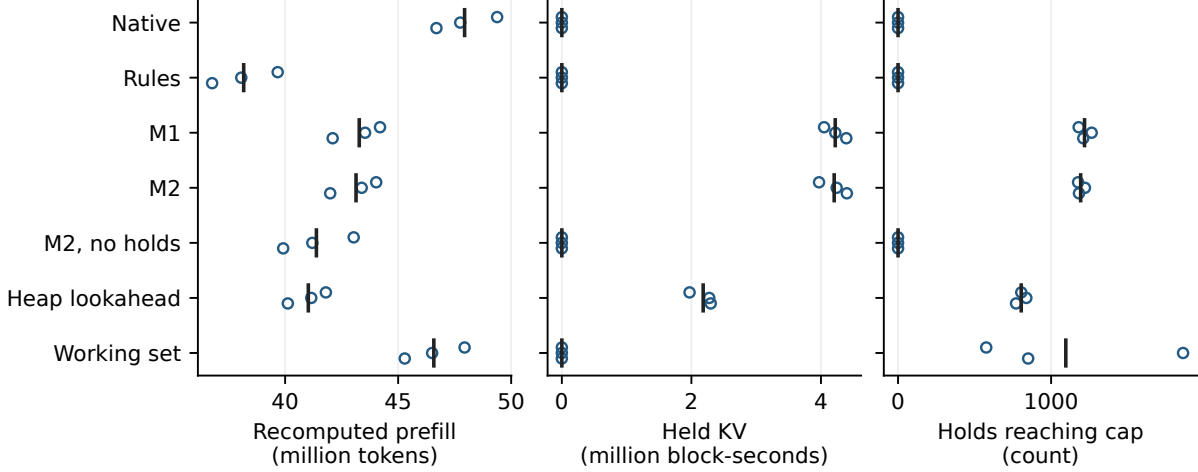


Figure 15: Additional costs in the loaded 600-second-cap regime. Open circles are the three seed values; dark vertical marks are their arithmetic means. Lower values indicate less recomputation, fewer retained block-seconds during holds, or fewer cap hits, respectively. These metrics measure distinct costs and are not combined into a single score. Zero held-KV accounting for the working-set arm does not imply zero delay, since paused state can be evicted.

Table B1: Loaded long-tool regime. TTFT is the arithmetic mean of per-seed p95 values, not the p95 of pooled calls. Deadline attainment is pooled over common sessions. Recomputed prefill and held-cache occupancy are in millions per seed; cap counts are means per seed.

Arm	p95 TTFT (s)	Deadline (%)	Recompute (M tokens)	Held KV (M block-s)	At cap
Native	2.67	19.0	47.94	0.00	0
Rules	3.01	24.7	38.17	0.00	0
Forecast M1	2.16	11.9	43.28	4.22	1,218
Forecast M2	2.12	12.2	43.14	4.20	1,193
M2, no holds	3.23	24.3	41.38	0.00	0
Heap lookahead	2.51	9.1	41.03	2.18	805
Working set	2.29	11.4	46.58	0.00	1,096

Recomputed prefill counts work after eviction. Held KV integrates resident memory during a policy hold; zero held-KV accounting for the working-set arm does not imply zero delay, since paused state can be evicted. Cap counts do not bound subsequent window queueing.

In particular, held-cache accounting is an integral,

$$C_{\text{hold}} = \int_0^{T_{\text{run}}} \sum_i B_i^{\text{resident}}(u) \mathbf{1}[i \text{ is policy-held at } u] du, \quad (21)$$

where T_{run} is the simulation end time and $B_i^{\text{resident}}(u)$ is session i 's retained block count at time u . Its units are block-seconds: retaining 100 blocks for 20 seconds contributes 2,000 block-seconds. This quantity is neither peak memory nor total waiting time.